WM

WILL MAC COMMUNITY

Moderation & Appeals Handbook

A calm, fair and structured way to moderate the server, and to let people earn a second chance.

Calm
Never punish while mad

Fair
Start light, give reasons

Consistent
Same rule, same result

Logged
Every warning, mute, ban

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00 At a glance

The whole path from first warning to permanent ban on one page.

STEP 1

Verbal warning

No punishment. Start light.

STEP 2

Formal warning

Logged. Resets after 7-14 days of good behavior.

STEP 3

Mute

Spam, toxicity, minor rule breaks.

10-30 min | 1-3 h | 12-24 h | 2-3 days

STEP 4

Kick

Warning plus removal. They can rejoin.

Harassment after warnings | Ignoring staff | Drama

STEP 5

Temporary ban

Serious or repeated behavior.

1 day | 3 days | 7 days | 14-30 days

STEP 6

Permanent ban

Only for serious stuff.

Hate speech | Threats | Raiding | NSFW | Ban evasion

Skip the steps

Instant punishments

Raiding	Ban
Doxxing	Ban
Spam bots	Ban
Extreme harassment	Temp / perma

Before you punish

Four quick questions

- **Am I calm?** Never punish while mad.
- **Did I check the logs?** Facts first.
- **Did I give a reason?** Always.
- **Did I log it?** Every warning, mute and ban.

Appeals are open for any punishment. 24 hour wait, one appeal, 2-3 staff vote.

01 Moderation structure

Start light before jumping to punishments. Escalate step by step, and log every action.

Warning system

Base layer

1	2	3
1st warning	2nd warning	3rd warning
Verbal warning	**Formal warning**	**Small punishment**
No punishment	Logged	Mute

Reset warnings after about 7-14 days of good behavior. Optional, but fair.

Mute system

Spam, toxicity and minor rule breaks

1	2	3	4
1st mute	2nd mute	3rd mute	4th mute
10-30 minutes	**1-3 hours**	**12-24 hours**	**2-3 days**

→ If they keep going, **move to a temporary ban.**

Kick system

Mid-level issues or repeated problems

USE IT FOR

- Harassment after warnings
- Ignoring staff
- Causing drama

A kick is **a warning plus removal.** They can rejoin.

Temporary ban system

Serious or repeated behavior

1	2	3	4
1st temp ban	2nd temp ban	3rd temp ban	4th temp ban
1 day	3 days	7 days	14-30 days

Permanent ban

Only for serious stuff

- Hate speech
- Threats
- Raiding
- NSFW
- Ban evasion

Instant punishments

Some actions skip the warnings

Raiding	→ Instant ban
Doxxing	→ Instant ban
Extreme harassment	→ Temp or perma ban
Spam bots	→ Instant ban

Log everything

Log every **warning, mute and ban**. It helps staff stay consistent and gives appeals a record to check.

Strike system

Optional alternative to warnings

1 strike	→ Warning
2 strikes	→ Mute
3 strikes	→ Temp ban
4 strikes	→ Permanent ban

02 Staff rules

Very important. These come before any punishment.

No abusing power

Permissions are for the community, never for personal use.

Always give a reason

Every action has a clear, short reason in the log.

Stay calm

Don't punish while mad. Step away, then decide.

Be consistent

Same behavior, same result, for everyone.

03 Appeal system

Anyone can appeal a punishment: ban, mute, kick or warning. A panel votes. Nobody decides alone.

Punished — Ban, mute, kick or warning
→ **Wait 24h** — Cool-off period
→ **Appeal sent** — Website form
→ **2-3 staff review** — Check the evidence
→ **Vote** — Accept or deny
→ **Decision** — Message sent

Appeal rules

Before someone appeals, they must

Wait 24 hours

At least 24 hours must pass after the punishment.

Only ONE appeal

One appeal at a time. No duplicates.

Be respectful

No insults. Insults mean an instant denial.

Appeal form template

The questions every appeal answers

1. Discord username + ID
2. What were you punished for?
3. Do you understand what you did wrong?
4. Why should it be lifted?
5. What will you do differently?
6. Anything else you want to add? (optional)

04 Decisions and templates

How staff review an appeal and what happens next.

Staff review system

When someone submits an appeal

- **2-3 staff members** review every appeal.
- The person who issued the punishment **never decides alone**.
- They should recuse themselves from the vote.

Accept

Deny

Vote

Accepted

- Punishment is **lifted** (unbanned if it was a ban)
- Put them on **probation** for 1-2 weeks
- Any rule break during probation means an **instant ban**

Denied

- Send a **short reason**, like "Appeal denied due to lack of accountability"
- Optional: allow a retry after **7-14 days**

Auto-deny cases

Don't even consider appeals for

Raiding | Doxxing | Threats | Hate speech

Appeal response templates

Copy these into the decision message

ACCEPTED

"Your appeal has been accepted. Your punishment will be lifted, but you'll be on probation. Any further rule breaks may result in a harsher punishment or a permanent ban."

DENIED

"Your appeal has been denied. You may reapply in 1 day if applicable."

05 Evidence check and appeal tips

Make every decision on facts, and help users write a good appeal.

Evidence check

Staff should always

Check logs

Look at the full moderation history.

Check screenshots

Review any proof that was saved.

Check context

What happened before and after.

Appeal tips for users

You can show these to anyone who asks

Be honest

Staff check the logs. The truth always shows.

Take responsibility

Say what you did, plainly.

Don't blame others

Not the mods, not the rules.

Most people mess this up by **being too emotional**. Stay calm and stay specific.

A good appeal system is calm, fair and structured.

Start light. Give reasons. Log everything. Vote together. Treat every appeal the same way.

Appeals cover bans, mutes, kicks and warnings · link: applications site + **?type=appeal**